
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 1 Aspects of Dramatic Tragedy

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford International AQA Examinations 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Iago and Roderigo
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 1

IAGO

Forsooth, a great arithmetician,
One Michael Cassio, a Florentine—
A fellow almost damned in a fair wife—
That never set a squadron in the field,
Nor the division of a battle knows
More than a spinster—unless the bookish theoric,
Wherein the toga'd consuls can propose
As masterly as he! Mere prattle without practice
Is all his soldiership. But he, sir, had th'election;
And I—of whom his eyes had seen the proof
At Rhodes, at Cyprus, and on other grounds,
Christened and heathen—must be beleed and calmed
By debtor and creditor. This counter-caster,
He, in good time, must his lieutenant be,
And I—God bless the mark!—his Moorship's ensign.

RODERIGO

By heaven, I rather would have been his hangman!

IAGO

Why, there's no remedy, 'tis the curse of service:
Preferment goes by letter and affection,
And not by old gradation, where each second
Stood heir to th' first. Now sir, be judge yourself
Whether I in any just term am assigned
To love the Moor?

RODERIGO

I would not follow him then.

IAGO

O sir, content you.
I follow him to serve my turn upon him.
We cannot all be masters, nor all masters
Cannot be truly followed. You shall mark
Many a duteous and knee-crooking knave
That, doting on his own obsequious bondage,
Wears out his time, much like his master's ass,
For naught but provender, and when he's old—cashiered.
Whip me such honest knaves! Others there are
Who, trimmed in forms and visages of duty,
Keep yet their hearts attending on themselves,
And, throwing but shows of service on their lords,
Do well thrive by them, and when they have lined their coats
Do themselves homage. These fellows have some soul,
And such a one do I profess myself—for, sir,
It is as sure as you are Roderigo,
Were I the Moor, I would not be Iago:
In following him, I follow but myself—
Heaven is my judge, not I for love and duty,
But seeming so for my peculiar end;
For when my outward action doth demonstrate
The native act and figure of my heart
In compliment extern, 'tis not long after
But I will wear my heart upon my sleeve
For daws to peck at: I am not what I am.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Lear and the Fool
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 3 Scene 2

Storm. Enter King Lear and his Fool

LEAR

Blow, wind, and crack your cheeks! Rage, blow,
 You cataracts and hurricanoes, spout
 Till you have drenched the steeples, drowned the cocks!
 You sulphurous and thought-executing fires,
 Vaunt-couriers to oak-cleaving thunderbolts,
 Singe my white head; and thou all-shaking thunder,
 Smite flat the thick rotundity of the world,
 Crack nature's mould, all germens spill at once
 That make ingrateful man.

FOOL

O nuncle, court holy water in a dry house is better
 than this rain-water out o' door. Good nuncle, in, and
 ask thy daughters' blessing. Here's a night pities neither
 wise man nor fool.

LEAR

Rumble thy bellyful; spit, fire; spout, rain.
 Nor rain, wind, thunder, fire are my daughters.
 I task not you, you elements, with unkindness.
 I never gave you kingdom, called you children.
 You owe me no subscription. Why then, let fall
 Your horrible pleasure. Here I stand your slave,
 A poor, infirm, weak and despised old man,
 But yet I call you servile ministers,
 That have with two pernicious daughters joined
 Your high engendered battle 'gainst a head
 So old and white as this. O, 'tis foul!

FOOL

He that has a house to put his head in has a good
 headpiece.

[Sings]

The codpiece that will house
Before the head has any,
The head and he shall louse,
So beggars marry many.

The man that makes his toe
What he his heart should make
Shall have a corn cry woe,
And turn his sleep to wake—
for there was never yet fair woman but she made mouths
in a glass.

LEAR

No, I will be the pattern of all patience.
[He sits.] *Enter the Earl of Kent disguised*
I will say nothing.

KENT

Who's there?

FOOL

Marry, here's grace and a codpiece—that's a wise
man and a fool.

KENT [to Lear]

Alas, sir, sit you here? Things that love night
Love not such nights as these. The wrathful skies
Gallow the very wanderers of the dark
And makes them keep their caves. Since I was man
Such sheets of fire, such bursts of horrid thunder,
Such groans of roaring wind and rain I ne'er
Remember to have heard. Man's nature cannot carry
The affliction nor the force.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Polonius and Ophelia
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 3

POLONIUS

What is't, Ophelia, he hath said to you?

OPHELIA

So please you, something touching the Lord Hamlet.

POLONIUS

Marry, well bethought.

'Tis told me he hath very oft of late

Given private time to you, and you yourself

Have of your audience been most free and bounteous.

If it be so—as so 'tis put on me,

And that in way of caution—I must tell you

You do not understand yourself so clearly

As it behoves my daughter and your honour.

What is between you? Give me up the truth.

OPHELIA

He hath, my lord, of late made many tenders

Of his affection to me.

POLONIUS

Affection, pooh! You speak like a green girl

Unsifted in such perilous circumstance.

Do you believe his tenders, as you call them?

OPHELIA

I do not know, my lord, what I should think.

POLONIUS

Marry, I'll teach you. Think yourself a baby

That you have ta'en his tenders for true pay

Which are not sterling. Tender yourself more dearly,

Or—not to crack the wind of the poor phrase,

Running it thus—you'll tender me a fool.

OPHELIA

My lord, he hath importuned me with love

In honourable fashion.

POLONIUS

Ay, 'fashion' you may call it. Go to, go to.

OPHELIA

And hath given countenance to his speech, my lord,
With almost all the holy vows of heaven.

POLONIUS

Ay, springes to catch woodcocks. I do know
When the blood burns, how prodigal the soul
Lends the tongue vows. These blazes, daughter,
Giving more light than heat, extinct in both
Even in their promise as it is a-making,
You must not take for fire. From this time
Be somewhat scanter of your maiden presence,
Set your entreatments at a higher rate
Than a command to parley. For Lord Hamlet,
Believe so much in him, that he is young,
And with a larger tether may he walk
Than may be given you. In few, Ophelia,
Do not believe his vows, for they are brokers,
Not of the dye which their investments show,
But mere implorators of unholy suits,
Breathing like sanctified and pious bawds
The better to beguile. This is for all—
I would not, in plain terms, from this time forth
Have you so slander any moment leisure
As to give words or talk with the Lord Hamlet.
Look to't, I charge you. Come your ways.

OPHELIA

I shall obey, my lord.

Exeunt

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Prologue and Act 1 Scene 1

Enter Chorus.

CHORUS

Not marching in the fields of Trasimene
 Where Mars did mate the warlike Carthagens,
 Nor sporting in the dalliance of love
 In courts of kings where state is overturned,
 Nor in the pomp of proud audacious deeds,
 Intends our muse to vaunt his heavenly verse.
 Only this, gentles: we must now perform
 The form of Faustus' fortunes, good or bad.
 And now to patient judgements we appeal,
 And speak for Faustus in his infancy.
 Now is he born, of parents base of stock,
 In Germany, within a town called Rhode.
 At riper years to Wittenberg he went,
 Whereas his kinsmen chiefly brought him up.
 So much he profits in divinity
 That shortly he was graced with doctor's name,
 Excelling all, and sweetly can dispute
 In th'heavenly matters of theology;
 Till, swoll'n with cunning of a self-conceit,
 His waxen wings did mount above his reach,
 And, melting, heavens conspired his overthrow.
 For, falling to a devilish exercise,
 And glutted now with learning's golden gifts,
 He surfeits upon cursèd necromancy;
 Nothing so sweet as magic is to him,
 Which he prefers before his chiefest bliss.
 And this the man that in his study sits.

[Exit]

Faustus in his study.

FAUSTUS

Settle thy studies, Faustus, and begin
To sound the depth of that thou wilt profess.
Having commenced, be a divine in show,
Yet level at the end of every art,
And live and die in Aristotle's works.
Sweet *Analytics*, 'tis thou hast ravished me!
[He reads] '*Bene disserere est finis logices.*'
Is to dispute well logic's chiefest end?
Affords this art no greater miracle?
Then read no more; thou hast attained that end.
A greater subject fitteth Faustus' wit.
Bid *Oeconomy* farewell, and Galen, come!
Be a physician, Faustus. Heap up gold,
And be eternized for some wondrous cure.
[He reads] '*Summum bonum medicinae sanitas*':
The end of physic is our body's health.
Why, Faustus, hast thou not attained that end?
Are not thy bills hung up as monuments,
Whereby whole cities have escaped the plague
And thousand desperate maladies been cured?
Yet art thou still but Faustus, and a man.
Couldst thou make men to live eternally,
Or, being dead, raise them to life again,
Then this profession were to be esteemed.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Antonio and Bosola
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]**Act 2 Scene 3**

[Enter Bosola with a dark lantern]

BOSOLA

Sure I did hear a woman shriek: list, ha?
 And the sound came, if I received it right,
 From the Duchess' lodgings. There's some stratagem
 In the confining all our courtiers
 To their several wards. I must have part of it,
 My intelligence will freeze else. List again!
 It may be 'twas the melancholy bird,
 Best friend of silence and of solitariness,
 The owl, that screamed so.

[Enter Antonio]

Ha! Antonio!

ANTONIO

I heard some noise. Who's there? What art thou? Speak.

BOSOLA

Antonio? Put not your face nor body
 To such a forced expression of fear:
 I am Bosola, your friend.

ANTONIO

Bosola!

[Aside] This mole does undermine me. *[To him]* Heard you not
 A noise even now?

BOSOLA

From whence?

ANTONIO

From the Duchess' lodging.

BOSOLA

Not I. Did you?

ANTONIO

I did: or else I dreamed.

BOSOLA

Let's walk towards it.

ANTONIO

No: it may be 'twas

But the rising of the wind.

BOSOLA

Very likely.

Methinks 'tis very cold, and yet you sweat.

You look wildly.

ANTONIO

I have been setting a figure

For the Duchess' jewels.

BOSOLA

Ah, and how falls your question?

Do you find it radical?

ANTONIO

What's that to you?

'Tis rather to be questioned what design,

When all men were commanded to their lodgings,

Makes you a night-walker.

BOSOLA

In sooth I'll tell you:

Now all the court's asleep, I thought the devil

Had least to do here; I came to say my prayers.

And if it do offend you I do so,

You are a fine courtier.

ANTONIO [*aside*]

This fellow will undo me.

[*To him*] You gave the Duchess apricots today;

Pray heaven they were not poisoned!

BOSOLA

Poisoned! A Spanish fig

For the imputation.

ANTONIO

Traitors are ever confident,

Till they are discovered. There were jewels stol'n too;

In my conceit, none are to be suspected

More than yourself.

BOSOLA

You are a false steward.

ANTONIO

Saucy slave! I'll pull thee up by the roots.

BOSOLA

Maybe the ruin will crush you to pieces.

ANTONIO

You are an impudent snake indeed, sir;

Are you scarce warm, and do you show your sting?

This extract continues on the next page

[BOSOLA] ...

ANTONIO

You libel well, sir.

BOSOLA

No, sir, copy it out,
And I will set my hand to't.

ANTONIO *[aside]*

My nose bleeds.

[He draws an initialled handkerchief]

One that were superstitious would count
This ominous, when it merely comes by chance:
Two letters, that are wrought here for my name,
Are drowned in blood!
Mere accident. *[To him]* For you, sir, I'll take order:
I' th' morn you shall be safe. *[Aside]* 'Tis that must colour
Her lying-in. *[To him]* Sir, this door you pass not:
I do not hold it fit that you come near
The Duchess' lodgings, till you have quit yourself.
[Aside] The great are like the base, nay, they are the same,
When they seek shameful ways to avoid shame.

Exit [Antonio]

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

'The Requiem merely confirms what the audience already thinks. Willy's life has been shown to be a tragic failure.'

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

'Stella is too colourless a character to have any real impact on the tragedy of *A Streetcar Named Desire*.'

How far do you agree with this view of the way that Stella is presented in the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

'The respectability of the world of *Hedda Gabler* is an illusion. It is a totally flawed society where violence is always close to the surface.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the way society is presented in the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler*?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

How far do you agree that the comic elements of *Waiting for Godot* merely distract the audience from the tragic impact of the play?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

How far does the fact that *Translations* is set in the past mean that the tragedy has no real relevance to a modern audience?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

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